

Python playground

The shell window can be used to try out all sorts of Python commands, including drawing. The turtle is used to draw on screen in the same way that the pen is used in Scratch.

```
>>> from turtle import *
>>> forward(100)
>>> right(120)
>>> forward(100)
```

Loads all the commands
that control the turtle

◁ Enter the code

Type these instructions in the shell window. They run after each one is typed. As the turtle moves, it draws a line.

Moves the turtle forward

◁ Turtle graphic

Can you work out how to draw other shapes, such as a square or a pentagon?
To start over, type "clear()" into the shell window.

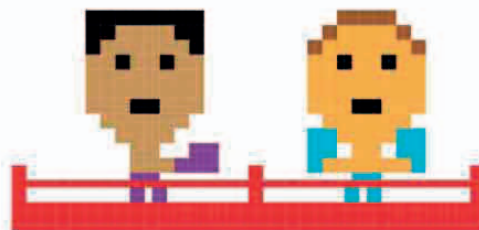
Which window should you use?

Should you use the code window or the shell window? It depends on the type of program you're writing, and whether it has to be repeated.

▷ Code window

The code window is ideal for longer pieces of code because they can be saved and edited. It's easier than retyping all the instructions if you want to do the same thing again or try something similar. It needs to be saved and run each time, though.

Code vs Shell



◁ Shell window

The shell window is perfect for quick experiments, such as checking how a command works. It's also a handy calculator. It doesn't save the instructions though, so if you're trying something you might want to repeat, consider using the code window instead.



EXPERT TIPS

Colors in the code

IDLE color-codes the text. The colors give you some clues about what Python thinks each piece of text is.



◁ Built-in functions

Commands in Python, such as "print", are shown in purple.



◁ Strings in quotes

Green indicates strings. If the brackets are green too, there's a missing quote mark.



◁ Most symbols and names

Most code is shown in black.



◁ Output

Python's output in the shell window is shown in blue.



◁ Keywords

Keywords, such as "if" and "else", are orange. Python won't let you use keywords as variable names.



◁ Errors

Python uses red to alert you to any error messages in the shell window.